

interface you use to navigate around a capacitive touch screen through multi-touch gestures is under Apple's ownership. Understandably, with manufacturers adopting this technology to more and more communication and entertainment devices, Apple has time and again needed to settle patent disputes in courts.

So, how did Apple's journey of taking over people's imagination and their phoning habits, start? For quite some time now, engineers and scientists have been working on making handheld devices even more personal and by the 1990s the cool new thing was the touch interface. Hewlett



Newton PDA, which laid the foundation for all future Apple touch screen devices, meets the iPhone; image: Wikipedia

Packard had already introduced the HP-150, a home computer with a touch screen which detected finger movements and soon people were adapting the technology onto smaller and smaller devices. The nineties introduced the now so common smart phones, with Apple releasing its initial entry into this market – the Newton PDA. It

was a personal digital assistant with handwriting recognition and their first tablet platform – the predecessor of iOS used in the iPhone, iPod Touch and iPad. It was followed closely by IBM introducing their own smart phone – Simon, which boasted a calendar, note pad and even fax along with a touch screen to dial numbers. In 1996, Palm dominated the PDA market with its Pilot series and 2002 had Microsoft foray into this segment with the Windows XP tablet edition starting their own touch screen ventures. But none of these attempts quite compare to the craze and charisma of the evergreen, everlasting Apple iPhone (and eventually the iPad).

Almost half a decade ago in 2007, Steve Jobs showcased the king of all next generation smart phones – sleek, user friendly and working entirely on the touch technology. Was it the design or the user-interface or the